

**LISTENING COMPREHENSION LESSON: Listening at the Restaurant****DICTATION TRANSCRIPT**

I can't believe the bad service at that restaurant last night. The hostess had a peculiar way of talking. I swear she told us that it would be a 20 minute wait, but it wound up being an hour. I was so upset that I was going to complain to the manager, but then we were finally seated, and I simply wanted to enjoy my meal without getting agitated about the wait. Unfortunately, that proved impossible. Our waiter was incompetent and almost immediately messed up our drink orders. Then, I asked for a steak cooked medium rare, and he brought me one well done. The steak was so horrible that I refused to pay for it and requested a refund. I cannot comprehend why the wait was so long for such a terrible restaurant. Who would stand in line for such bad service? It's beyond me!

**VOCABULARY**

1. **Dictation**-n. The act of writing word for word spoken language. The secretary took dictation during the meeting so the directors could reference all their ideas later.
2. **Tally**-n. & v. to keep account or to keep score usually by making a mark to register a certain number of items. He kept a tally of his golf swings so he can keep track of any improvements.
3. **Peculiar**-adj. strange. He is a peculiar character who only comes out at night.
4. **Agitate**-v. to move or shake briskly; to disturb. The woman was agitated because the dry cleaner lost her dress.
5. **Incompetent**-adj. lacking ability; incapable. I would not trust Sam to complete that project. He proved incompetent while managing the last one.
6. **It's beyond me**-an expression meaning that I don't understand. It's beyond comprehension.
7. **Nuance**-n. the small details of something. Every nuance in this report must be perfect when the director reviews it.

## READING COMPREHENSION ANSWER SHEET

Passage 1 Answers

1. B
2. C
3. A
4. D
5. B

Passage 2 Answers

1. B
2. B
3. C
4. A
5. D

## VOCABULARY

1. **Prophesied**-v. to tell the future; to predict. Nostradamus prophesied the death of the king.
2. **Prediction**-n. a statement about the future; a forecast; a prophesy. My prediction is that Brazil will win the World Cup this year.
3. **Efficiently**-adv. To function in the best possible manner. My air conditioner is old and is no longer cooling efficiently.
4. **Over the long haul**-phrase. Over a long period of time. Over the long haul, it's better to invest in stocks than to keep your money locked in a safe.
5. **Discern**-v. to discover something, or to realize something through steady thinking. Because of a lack of evidence, the police detective was unable to discern who the thief could be.
6. **Decade**-n. a period of ten years. The 1970's was my favorite decade because I loved the fashion and the music created then.
7. **Radical**-adj. extreme in terms of making changes, or in political beliefs. His generous donation will make a radical difference in supplying resources to the hurricane victims.
8. **Contrast**-n. to compare; to show differences. The sunny beaches of Aruba are a welcomed contrast to the snowy winter we are having in New York.
9. **Crucially**-adv. Extremely important. The homeless shelter depends crucially on community volunteers and donations.
10. **Cohort**-n. a group; The doctors had a conference to discuss a cohort of patients who get infections after surgery.
11. **Extent**-n. the degree to which a thing extends. His theory may be right to a certain extent, but there are many other contributing factors to this issues.

12. **Burden**-n. the weight of carrying something heavy; a difficult obligation. Because of his illness, Sam felt like a burden to his family, however, his loving family was happy to take care him.
13. **Rearing**-v. to take care of; to raise to maturity. While she was pregnant, she read dozens of books on child rearing.
14. **Utility**-n. to be useful; a public service such as the telephone company, electric company, and water company. I wonder about the utility of riding a bike to work when so many people day cars.
15. **Obstacle**-n. something that obstructs or hinders progress. The athletes had to run through an obstacle course of hoops, hurdles, and a rock wall to win the grand prize.
16. **Innovation**-n. something new or different with techniques or methods. Innovations in home television sets make it possible to get a theater-like experience in the comfort of your home.
17. **Implementation**-n. to take action; to put something into effect. Government officials are meeting to discuss the implementation of new energy conservation regulations.
18. **Lobby**-v. to try to influence the actions of public officials and law makers. Gun activists continually lobby Congress to make sure that there are no new laws resisting public access to guns.
19. **Augment**-v. to increase; to make larger; to strengthen. This training will augment your knowledge of the English language.

**READING COMPREHENSION WORKSHEET**

**DIRECTIONS:** Please read the following passage, and answer the questions below. The correct answers are listed on the following handout, and there is a vocabulary review at the end.

**PASSAGE 1**

1            John Maynard Keynes, a great British economist, prophesied that by 2030 people in wealthy  
2 nations would work no more than 15 hours a week. However, it isn't turning out that way. In America  
3 for example, the average workweek for full-time workers isn't anywhere close to Keynes's predictions.  
4 Current estimates are 34 to 47 hours, depending on what exactly is being measured and whether or not  
5 part-time work is being counted.

6            The trend isn't moving in Keynes's direction either. The workweek hasn't fallen much since  
7 World War II. To some extent, leisure time has gone up, but this is mostly due to household chores  
8 being done more efficiently and because some people have lost their jobs.

9            The Great Recession had a major effect on the labor supply numbers, but over the long haul we  
10 can discern some patterns among gender and age groups. Older people do work much less than they  
11 did decades ago. Fewer than 20 percent of men over 65 are in the work force today. We tend to take  
12 this for granted, but it's a radical contrast with 1880, when that figure was about 75 percent.

13           Teenagers are also ahead of Keynes's workplace predictions. Several decades ago, about 55  
14 percent of teenagers had jobs, but lately only about 35 percent do. In addition, service sector jobs have  
15 been replacing jobs involving manual labor. While enormous disparities exist among teenagers of  
16 different races and income groups, over all, life has gotten easier for them.

17           A crucially important cohort is working less, too, though not as little as Keynes expected. In  
18 2014, about 12 percent of American men ages 25 to 54 neither had jobs nor were looking for work,  
19 compared with about 8 percent in 1994. With a healthier job market, more of those men would  
20 probably be working.

21           If people in all these groups are working less, then someone must be working more. The  
22 answer, overwhelmingly, is women, who have taken on an Atlaslike role in supporting American  
23 economic growth. There are reasons to believe that at least some of the growth in female work hours  
24 has been an unfair burden. It is well known, for instance, that men do not come anywhere close to fully  
25 sharing in the household chores or child rearing when their partners are working, and that often means  
26 more stress for women. Overall, female happiness in America has been declining, while age-adjusted  
27 death rates for middle-ages white women — though not for white men — have been increasing. Those  
28 troubling trends are perhaps another sign that the distribution of stress has been uneven. In short, we  
29 hear plenty of talk about income inequality these days, but issues surrounding the inequality of work  
30 itself may be no less important.

**QUESTIONS**

1. What was economist John Maynard Keynes's prediction for the future?
  - a. In the future, people will have more leisure time.
  - b. People in wealthy nations would work less hours.
  - c. Women would join the workforce.
  - d. Women would work longer hours.
2. Which group is working more than ever before?
  - a. Teenagers
  - b. Elderly
  - c. Women
  - d. Men
3. The term Atlaslike (line 22) refers to women's
  - a) Tremendous strength
  - b) Consumerism
  - c) Navigation capabilities
  - d) Delicate manners
4. All of the following can be inferred from the text except...
  - a) Men ages 25-54 are working less due to a poor job market.
  - b) There is an overall increase in leisure time due to better time management.
  - c) Due to stress, death rates of middle-aged women are increasing.
  - d) Working women and men currently share an equal burden of household duties and child rearing.
5. The author believes it is important to address which problem?
  - a) The decrease in jobs caused by the recession
  - b) The unfair burden of work performed by women at their jobs and at home
  - c) The increase of the retirement age
  - d) The lack of teenagers in the workforce

**ESSAY 2: DRONES**

Drone technology is growing in both utility and popularity. Although widely well known for their warfare capabilities, retailers such as Amazon are also piloting a project to use drones to deliver packages. Such plans could have packages delivered to eager customers in as little as 30 minutes, however several obstacles stand in the way of this drone technology being widely used.

In the United States, for example, the Federal Aviation Administration limits drone testing, restricting drone operators from navigating their machines out of line of sight due to public safety concerns. However, new policies in Britain are encouraging more innovation in drone technology. Developers currently are testing flying a drone many miles out of sight in rural and suburban areas, and if a single operator can control multiple drones at the same time. Amazon hopes that these tests once proven safe will make implementation into other countries easier in the future.

Tech giants like Amazon and Google continue to lobby the Federal Aviation Administration in the U.S. in hope that they can educate legislators about their progress in Britain hoping that successful tests will augment confidence in drone safety.

**QUESTIONS**

1. What is the primary purpose of this passage?
  - a. To discuss the feud between Amazon and Google
  - b. To discuss obstacles in producing new drone technology
  - c. To list ways the United States can improve its relationship with Great Britain
  - d. To stigmatize drones as dangerous warfare machines
2. What is the main challenge in implementing worldwide drone usage?
  - a) Drones are not capable of flying out of line of sight.
  - b) Some countries forbid drone testing.
  - c) There are not enough trained drone operators.
  - d) Many people are not interested in buying drone technology.**
3. Drone innovators are currently testing all but the following?
  - a) Ways to pilot more than one drone at a time
  - b) Out of line of sight flying
  - c) Animal testing
  - d) Package delivery capabilities
4. The U.S. Federal Aviation Administration prohibits what type of drone testing?
  - a) Out of line of sight testing
  - b) Delivery testing
  - c) Surveillance drone testing
  - d) Irrigation drone testing

5. The word “lobby” (line 11) most nearly means...

- a) To avoid
- b) To sue
- c) To resist
- d) To influence